

unsent letters

i have a pen and paper; i write voraciously;
iterations of your name in damning cursive,
no furnace to extinguish or bin to use,
instead i mail them out to my acquaintances.
they read your name with no spirit; no intensity;
no religious fervor or reverence: blasphemy.

my altar to you is decorated with lipstick stains
and yolk buns, merlot bandages and sharpener blades.
knees ripped and throat raw; i intone hymns,
only your *i love yous* repeated, an incantation
all under shuttered windows and closed doors,

you make no notice. in the middle of my
room, you stand and stare at my worship while
barely holding my hand. secretly, our finger
pads make contact, sweat translations.
secretly, you stare back in the courtyard.
secretly, we talk until curfew.
secretly: you take my heart,
secretly? you take it and run.

i wait for the money you dropped;
like my heartstrings you plucked erratically.
my letters burn, sent to their return address,
in record time, they forget about you.
(i forget too?) remember our secrets? i dont.
my grudges harden for your best friends.

the pen wont run out of ink. the forest doesnt run out of trees.
i write past my bleeding knuckles, till the bones in my fingers erupt:
like your arms? i can only hope i was the first;
i dont trace your name. instead: the outline of questions;
all unsent.
when i send it, we will be there, in our mountain home.
you, with a hawk on your hand.
you, with faded scars.
me, with you.